Unit 7 — Being a Friend

Track E · Klasse 7 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can listen to a short conversation about a friendship problem and identify what each speaker is doing in the exchange (asking, reassuring, advising).*
- *I can use first-conditional if-clauses to give and respond to advice.*
- *I can hold a 2-minute conversation about a small friendship misunderstanding.*

Lead-in I

Ben sat down beside Aisha at lunch and pushed his tray away without eating. ”I think Marius hates me,” he said. Aisha put down her sandwich. ”Did you ask him?” ”No.” ”Then technically you have invented a person who hates you. Maybe try the real one first.” Ben rolled his eyes, but he also smiled — which is what Aisha was waiting for.

Reading I

Listening — *Two Best Friends*
Listen with closed books.
Ben. Aisha, can I tell you something without you laughing?
Aisha. Probably not. But I'll try.
Ben. I think Marius is mad at me. He didn't talk to me at lunch.
Aisha. Did you ask him why?
Ben. No. I just decided he hates me now.
Aisha. Ben. Sometimes people just have a bad lunch. Go ask him tomorrow before you spend the whole evening building a theory.

Reading II

Ben. That sounds annoyingly sensible.
Aisha. I am annoyingly sensible. That's why you tell me things.

Language focus — first conditional
Use the **first conditional** to talk about real future possibilities and their results.

- *If* + present simple, *will* + base verb.
- *If you ask him, you will find out the truth.*
- *If we don't talk, the problem will get worse.*

Reading III

Comma rule: when *if* comes first, write a comma. When *if* is in the middle, no comma.

- *If you ask him, you will find out.*
- *You will find out if you ask him.*

Language focus — adjective + preposition
Many English adjectives are followed by a fixed preposition. They need to be learned together, like a single word.

Reading IV

- *afraid of*, *good at*, *bad at*, *interested in*, *worried about*, *excited about*, *proud of*, *jealous of*, *sorry for*, *annoyed by/with*.

L1 trap. German *Angst vor* maps to English *afraid of* (not *before*). German *gut in* maps to English *good at*. Memorise the pair, not the preposition alone.

Practise I

Niveau G — controlled
A. First conditional gap-fill.

1. If you _____ (ask) him, he _____ (tell) you.
2. If we _____ (apologise), they _____ (be) happy.
3. If I _____ (not / call) her, she _____ (be) sad.

B. Adjective + preposition. Insert the missing preposition.

4. Ben is afraid _____ asking the wrong question.

Practise II

5. Aisha is good _____ giving advice.

Niveau M — productive
C. Build advice with *if*. A friend tells you the situation; you give one if-sentence in reply.

6. ”I lost my best friend’s umbrella.” → ___
7. ”My partner forgot my birthday.” → ___
8. ”I said something mean by accident.” → ___

D. Adjective + preposition free-build. Make one true sentence about yourself with each of: *interested in*, *proud of*, *worried about*.

Your turn I

Pair speaking — *The Wise One.* Each pair takes one of these prompts and runs a 2-minute conversation. One person describes a small friendship problem; the other gives advice using **at least three if-clauses** and **at least one adjective + preposition**.

- *My friend keeps cancelling at the last minute.*
- *Someone in my group chat shared a private message.*
- *My oldest friend is suddenly hanging out with a new group.*

Your turn II

Swap roles after two minutes.
Strong moves: real eye contact, specific advice (not just ”talk to them”), and a single exchange of disagreement (*”Yeah but …”*) before resolution.

Reflect I

- I can pick out who is asking, reassuring, and advising in a short dialogue.
- I can give advice with a first-conditional if-clause.
- I know three adjective+preposition combinations.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Bitesize — *First conditional*. https://www.bbc.co.uk/bitesize/topics/zhfygdm
- Childline (UK) — short articles on friendship and falling-outs. https://www.childline.org.uk/info-advice/friends-relationships-sex/friends/falling-out-friends
- The Guardian — *Dear Mariella* / advice columns at A2/B1 reading level. https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle